AI Video Bootcamp

AI VIDEO BOOTCAMP

Style Reference Library

24 Visual Styles With Example Prompts You Can Steal

How To Use This Library

Each style below includes: what it looks like, when to use it, and an example prompt. Add the style keywords at the END of your prompt after your scene description. Don't lead with the style.

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35mm Film

Look: Warm tones, natural grain, slightly soft focus, organic color shifts. The look of analog photography.
Use when: When you want that timeless, nostalgic, "this feels real" quality.
Prompt: "A couple walking through a flea market on a Sunday morning, the woman holding a vintage vase she just found, shot on 35mm film"

Polaroid

Look: Square format, faded colors, slight vignette, soft warm tones, white border frame.
Use when: Instant nostalgia. Great for casual, personal, intimate moments.
Prompt: "Friends sitting on a rooftop at sunset, passing around beers, someone is laughing, taken on a polaroid camera"

Cinematic Widescreen

Look: 2.39:1 aspect ratio, shallow depth of field, dramatic lighting, color graded.
Use when: Hero shots, establishing shots, anything that needs to feel like a movie.
Prompt: "A lone samurai walking through bamboo forest in the rain, cinematic widescreen, moody lighting"

Anime/Manga

Look: Clean lines, vibrant colors, expressive characters, stylized backgrounds.
Use when: Character design, fantasy scenes, anything that needs an animated look.
Prompt: "A girl sitting on a rooftop overlooking a neon-lit futuristic city at night, anime style, vibrant colors"

Oil Painting

Look: Visible brush strokes, rich colors, dramatic light, classical composition.
Use when: Fantasy, historical, dramatic or epic scenes.
Prompt: "A stormy seascape with a small sailing ship, dramatic clouds, in the style of a classical oil painting"

Watercolor

Look: Soft edges, transparent washes of color, white paper showing through, dreamy.
Use when: Gentle, delicate subjects. Nature, florals, soft portraits.
Prompt: "A field of wildflowers with a small cottage in the distance, morning mist, painted in soft watercolor"

Pencil Sketch

Look: Graphite on paper, varying line weight, cross-hatching for shadows, raw.
Use when: Concept art, architectural studies, character design, raw creative energy.
Prompt: "An old man's face with deep wrinkles, detailed pencil sketch on cream paper, expressive eyes"

Pop Art

Look: Bold primary colors, thick outlines, halftone dots, high contrast.
Use when: Bold statements, brand content, playful and eye-catching.

Prompt: "A woman drinking coffee with a surprised expression, bold pop art style, bright primary colors, comic book dots"

Film Noir

Look: High contrast black and white, dramatic shadows, venetian blind lighting.
Use when: Mystery, drama, sophistication, moody storytelling.
Prompt: "A detective standing under a streetlight in an empty alley, cigarette smoke rising, film noir, black and white, dramatic shadows"

Vintage Magazine

Look: Clean composition, warm muted tones, grain, styled like 1960s editorial.
Use when: Fashion content, lifestyle brands, retro-inspired projects.
Prompt: "A woman in a trench coat walking through a Paris street market, styled like a 1960s magazine editorial"

Editorial Fashion

Look: High-end styling, dramatic poses, controlled lighting, magazine-quality.
Use when: Fashion brands, luxury products, high-end social content.
Prompt: "Model in an oversized blazer standing in an empty white studio, strong directional light from the left, editorial fashion photography"

Street Photography

Look: Candid, urban, raw, decisive moment captured, real-world setting.
Use when: Authentic-feeling content, urban stories, real-world scenes.
Prompt: "A delivery driver checking his phone on a busy corner in New York, steam rising from a manhole, golden hour"

Drone Photography

Look: Aerial perspective, patterns from above, sense of scale, bird's eye view.
Use when: Landscapes, architecture, revealing scale and pattern.
Prompt: "Aerial view of a winding coastal road along turquoise cliffs in Greece, tiny white car on the road, drone photography"

Macro Photography

Look: Extreme close-up, incredible detail on tiny subjects, shallow depth.
Use when: Product details, nature, textures, anything where detail matters.
Prompt: "A single drop of water on a green leaf, you can see the reflection of the forest in the droplet, macro photography"

Double Exposure

Look: Two images blended into one, usually a portrait merged with nature or city.
Use when: Creative portraits, symbolic storytelling, artistic social content.

Prompt: "A woman's silhouette filled with a mountain forest landscape, double exposure effect, moody and atmospheric"

Long Exposure

Look: Motion blur on moving elements, sharp static elements, light trails.
Use when: Night cityscapes, waterfalls, traffic, conveying motion in a still image.
Prompt: "A waterfall in a forest with smooth silky water from long exposure, mossy rocks, peaceful and serene"

Tilt-Shift

Look: Makes real scenes look like miniature models, selective focus band.
Use when: Making normal scenes look like toy models, creative perspective.
Prompt: "A busy intersection in Tokyo from above, tilt-shift effect making the cars and people look like tiny models"

Golden Hour Portrait

Look: Warm backlight, golden skin tones, sun flare, magic hour glow.
Use when: Portraits, lifestyle, any content that needs warmth and beauty.
Prompt: "A woman laughing with her eyes closed in a wheat field, golden hour backlight catching her hair, warm and joyful"

Studio Lighting

Look: Controlled, dramatic, clean background, professional.
Use when: Product photography, headshots, clean brand content.
Prompt: "A pair of white sneakers on a clean grey background, soft studio lighting, slight shadow underneath"

Dark Academia

Look: Muted browns, warm candlelight, old books, classical architecture.
Use when: Education content, literary vibes, intellectual aesthetic.
Prompt: "A stack of old leather-bound books on a mahogany desk, reading glasses on top, candlelight, dark academia aesthetic"

Vaporwave

Look: Neon pink and blue, glitch effects, retro-futuristic, 80s digital aesthetic.
Use when: Bold social content, music-related, nostalgic-futuristic branding.
Prompt: "A retro computer setup with neon pink and blue lighting, palm tree in the background, vaporwave aesthetic, glowing grid floor"

Cottagecore

Look: Soft natural light, meadows, flowers, linen, handmade, pastoral.
Use when: Lifestyle brands, natural products, wellness, food content.
Prompt: "A woman in a linen dress picking wildflowers in a sun-drenched meadow, wicker basket, soft cottagecore aesthetic"

Cyberpunk

Look: Neon-lit dystopia, rain-slicked streets, holographic ads, tech-heavy.
Use when: Sci-fi content, tech brands, futuristic storytelling.
Prompt: "A street vendor selling noodles under a neon sign in a rainy cyberpunk alley, holographic advertisements reflecting in puddles"

Minimalist

Look: Clean, simple, lots of negative space, one focal point.
Use when: Clean brand content, modern design, luxury, when less is more.
Prompt: "A single red chair in the center of a vast white room, soft even lighting, minimalist, clean"

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